# Antonio Villani

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## Education

**PhD Candidate in Economics**, Universitat Pompeu Fabra 2022–2027 (expected)
Advisors: Prof. Priit Jeenas and Prof. Jordi Galí

**Master of Research in Economics, Finance and Management** (2nd year, PhD track), 2021–2022
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

**Master's Degree in Economics and Finance** (1st year, PhD track), 2020–2021
Barcelona School of Economics

**BA(Econ)(Hons) Economics and Philosophy**, The University of Manchester 2017–2020
First Class Honours
Thesis: "A defence of Salmon's Neo-Russellianism" (philosophy of language and logic)

## Research Fields

Macroeconomics, Financial Economics, Monetary Economics, Firm Dynamics

## References

**Priit Jeenas**
Assistant Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

**Jordi Galí**
Senior Researcher
CREi

**Jan Eeckhout**
ICREA Research Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

**Dmitry Kuvshinov**
Associate Professor
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

## Job Market Paper

**The Effects of Corporate Purchase Programmes on Market Power** [Draft]

Does unconventional monetary policy affect the market power of firms? I address this question both empirically and theoretically. Comparing firms purchased under the European Central Bank's Corporate Sector Purchase Programme with eligible but unpurchased ones in a staggered difference-in-differences design, I show that a purchase raises a firm's markups by 7.1 percent. The transmission channel runs from issuing conditions to capital: purchased bonds are issued at a 22 basis point lower yield to maturity, and purchased firms invest 2.2 percentage points more. These effects materialise only under two conditions: purchases must be repeated over the years, and they must happen within a week of the bond issuance. A general equilibrium model rationalises these findings, combining endogenous markups and financial frictions. In a segmented bond market, a purchase raises the price of the very issue it absorbs, relaxes the issuer's capital constraint, and thus raises its output, market share and markup. A quantitative version compares different purchase designs: several, including the ECB's own with its deviations from market neutrality, deliver almost the same welfare gain, while concentrating purchases on a few large firms or directing them to the smallest eligible ones reduces it.

## Work in Progress

**Synthetic Risk Transfers: Effects on Financial Fragility and Redistribution** (with Gabriela Araujo)

**Sovereign Spreads, Cross-Country Redistribution and Quantitative Easing in a Monetary Union** (with Antonio Giribaldi and Iginio Marchesini Reggiani)

In a monetary union without a fiscal union, each government pays its own interest rate while its bonds are held across borders. Spread differentials that arise from financial frictions rather than default risk therefore redistribute resources between the households of different member states, a channel distinct from the level of interest rates. We document the interest flows that spread differentials generate across euro-area countries, using bilateral holdings imputed from the ECB's Securities Holdings Statistics. We then build a two-country New Keynesian model in which financial frictions generate these differentials. After a common financial shock, the spread of the more indebted country rises more, and resources flow from its households to those of the other country. Quantitative easing allocated by the capital key barely narrows the differential and leaves most of this redistribution in place; purchases targeted at the high-spread country close the differential and largely offset it.

## Conferences and Seminars

**2026** BSE PhD Jamboree; BSE Summer Forum (Financial Shocks, Channels and Macro Outcomes Workshop); International Ioannina Meeting on Applied Economics and Finance; SED Annual Meeting; EEA-ESEM Congress

**2025** CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Catalan Economic Society Congress; PhD Meetings in Economics; Madrid Mountain Macro Conference (poster); Naples School of Economics Workshop; Simposio de la Asociación Española de Economía

**2024** CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra); Imperial College PhD Conference in Economics and Finance; BSE PhD Jamboree

**2023** CREi Macro Lunch Seminar (Universitat Pompeu Fabra)

## Teaching Experience

**Barcelona School of Economics – Graduate Courses**

*Teaching Assistant for:*

"Advanced Macroeconomics III" (PhD track) — 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Jordi Galí and Priit Jeenas

**Universitat Pompeu Fabra – Undergraduate Courses**

*Teaching Assistant for:*

"Macroeconomics I" — 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Professors: Isaac Baley and Davide Debortoli

## Research and Professional Experience

**Research Assistant** – Prof. Jan Eeckhout, Universitat Pompeu Fabra — Oct 2026–Jul 2027

**Research Assistant** – Prof. Priit Jeenas, Barcelona School of Economics — Nov 2021–Jul 2023

## Additional Coursework

**2024** Difference-in-Differences and Event Study Estimators with Panel Data (by Jeffrey Wooldridge) – EABCN

## Awards and Scholarships

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| GPEFM PhD Track Fellowship, Universitat Pompeu Fabra | 2021–2026 |
| Dean Award for Achievement, The University of Manchester | 2020 |
| Stellify Award, The University of Manchester | 2020 |
| BA(Econ) Economics and other Social Sciences Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester | 2019 |
| Czeslaw Lejewski Logic Second Year Prize, The University of Manchester | 2019 |
| Gold Manchester Leadership Programme, The University of Manchester | 2019 |

## Languages and Technical Skills

**Languages:** Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (proficient), Greek (basic), Catalan (basic)

**Software and Programming:** MATLAB (advanced), R (advanced), Stata (advanced), LaTeX (advanced), Julia (intermediate), Python (basic)